

Elicitation Notes

Smart Recruitment - Funnel Optimization for Time-to-Hire Reduction

Technique Used: One-on-One Interviews (Head of TA, Senior Recruiter, HRIS/IT Lead) + Focus Group (Hiring Manager + Candidate Experience Rep)

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1. Session 1 - Senior Recruiter

45min, video call, Focus: screening and scheduling workflow

Q1. Walk me through what happens today when resumes come in for a requisition.

I get 100+ resumes per req, and I manually go through each one against the JD, there is no automated filtering. For 15-20 open requests at once, that's most of my week gone on just shortlisting.

Q2. Do you have a current average time-to-hire you'd consider a baseline?

Around 50 days is what we tell hiring managers, but honestly nobody's tracking it end-to-end; "if you asked me to prove that number today, I'd have to piece it together from three different trackers." Confirmed 48–55 days is a working estimate, not a measured baseline.

Q3. What SLA threshold would you consider acceptable for flagging a stalled requisition?

Anything sitting more than 2 days without action should get flagged. Wants an automatic alert, not a report she has to remember to check.

Q4. Should interview slots be auto-booked by the system, or should you approve each one?

Wants to review and approve before anything is sent to a candidate worried the system might book a slot that conflicts with something informal on a panel member's calendar. This is a potential conflict with automation goals; flagged for follow-up.

Q5. What would make this project a failure in your eyes?

"If I still have to keep a side spreadsheet to track anything the whole point is one place."

Session 2 - Head of Talent Acquisition (Sponsor)

40 min, video call. Focus: SLA design and prioritization.

Q1. What SLA thresholds matter most to you?

Screening should complete within 1 business day of resumes coming in; scheduling within 2 business days of shortlist. Wants automatic escalation to her if either is breached twice in a row for the same requisition.

Q2. Recruiters want to manually approve each scheduled slot before it's sent. Any concerns?

Pushed back wants full auto-booking for standard requisitions, arguing manual approval reintroduces the exact delay the project is meant to remove. This directly conflicts with the Senior Recruiter's Session 1, Q4. Not resolved in this session; escalated for follow-up.

Q3. How should the system handle candidates who don't respond to scheduling requests?

Auto-reminder after 24 hours, auto-escalation to recruiter after 48 hours with no response.

Q4. Are there requisition types that should NOT apply to initially?

Leadership and specialist roles too low-volume to justify standardized screening criteria yet.

Q5. Who signs off on the final screening/ranking criteria?

I do, jointly with a sample review from at least one hiring manager per role family.

Session 3 - HRIS/IT Lead

40 min, in-person. Focus: technical integration and data handling.

Q1. Can our HRIS integrate with a new ATS?

Yes, via API but candidate data fields will need careful mapping to avoid duplicate records between systems.

Q2. What's the minimum information the system needs to rank a resume?

Answered specifically; parsed skills, years of experience, education, and JD keyword match weighting. Anything beyond that adds processing time without much added accuracy.

Q3. Any concerns about candidate data handling?

Yes, candidate PII needs defined access controls and a retention policy; hasn't seen a data privacy requirement written down yet for this project. Flagged as an open item needs to be defined before FRD sign-off.

Q4. How should interview scheduling handle calendar conflicts?

Real-time sync against Outlook/Gmail calendars for all panel members; the system should never offer a slot that's already booked.

Q5. What's your estimate for the integration effort?

Roughly 4–5 weeks for API integration and testing, assuming clean data mapping from HRIS.

Session 4 - Hiring Manager

35 min, in-person. Focus: candidate quality and ranking trust.

Q1. What's frustrating about the current process?

Half the resumes I get don't actually match what I asked for in the JD.

Q2. Would you trust an automated ranking system?

Only if he can see *why* a candidate was ranked the way they were; "I'm not going to sign off on a black-box score." Wants visible scoring rationale (e.g., matched skills, experience gap) for every ranked candidate.

Q3. Should candidates see their own ranking or status details?

Just status ("under review," "interview scheduled") not the ranking rationale itself. Concerned that showing scoring logic to candidates could invite disputes or complaints about the criteria. This may be at odds with candidate-experience goals around transparency; flagged as an open item.

Q4. How do you want to give interview feedback going forward?

Structured scorecard with a hard deadline, not email he currently forgets to send feedback and knows it's a bottleneck on his end too.

Q5. Any features you'd explicitly want kept out of the pilot?

No interest in candidates seeing detailed ranking scores for now; wants to start simple and expand post-pilot based on what Recruiting actually reports.

Open Items From Elicitation

- **Scheduling approval model:** Senior Recruiter wants manual approval before slots are sent; Head of TA wants full auto-booking for standard requisitions. Unresolved — escalated for a joint session.
- **Candidate-facing status detail:** Hiring Manager wants ranking rationale kept internal-only; Candidate Experience goals lean toward more transparency to reduce "just checking in" inquiries. Needs a joint session before FRD finalization.
- **Candidate PII access/retention policy:** Not yet defined by HRIS/IT Lead; required before NFRs can be finalized in FRD.
- **No systematic baseline exists** for the 48–55 day time-to-hire figure treated as a working estimate, to be validated against historical requisition data if available.

Resolution Note (Added Week 4)

- Joint session held between Head of Talent Acquisition and Senior Recruiter. Outcome: standard requisitions default to full auto-booking (Head of TA's position), but the recruiter can manually pause and reassign a specific scheduling request within the first 4 hours if a panel conflict or priority issue is flagged; a middle position neither had proposed individually. This will be reflected as a business rule in the Business Rules Document.

- The candidate-facing status detail question (Hiring Manager vs. Candidate Experience) remains open and is carried forward to the Business Rules/FRD phase.